When AI Disagrees With You: How University Students Respond to Uncertain AI Answers

We are a group of three Computer Science and Engineering (CSE) students at **Vietnamese-German University (VGU)**, conducting a research project for our course **Data Analysis in High Dimensions**.

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About This Survey

As generative AI tools such as ChatGPT and Gemini become increasingly common in university coursework, students may encounter AI-generated answers that are confusing, contradictory, or unreliable.

Our research aims to explore **how students respond to these situations** and identify common response patterns using **Hierarchical Cluster Analysis**.

You will be presented with five hypothetical scenarios involving AI-generated answers. For each scenario, please select the **ONE action you would most likely take FIRST**.

Survey Information

- **Estimated duration:** 3–5 minutes

- **Eligibility:** Currently enrolled university students

- **Participation:** Voluntary and anonymous

- **Data usage:** Responses will be used exclusively for our academic course project and reported in aggregate form.

Instructions

There are **no right or wrong answers**. Please answer honestly based on what you would actually be most likely to do, rather than what you think is expected.

Please do not include your name, student ID, email address, or any personally identifiable information.

Thank you for taking the time to support our research!

* Indicates required question

Section 1 - Eligibility and consent

1. **S1. Are you currently enrolled as a university student?** *

   Mark only one oval.

   - ◯ Yes
   - ◯ No

2. **S2. Do you voluntarily agree to participate in this anonymous course project?** *

   Mark only one oval.

   - ◯ Yes
   - ◯ No

3. **S3. What is your current major or study program at VGU?** Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ECE
- MEN
- CSE
- BFA
- BBA
- BCE
- ARC
- SME
- SPE
- MEC
- BSE
- BDE
- BME
- COM
- MST
- SUD
- GPE
- BIS
- MBA
- WTE
- MCS
- MSI

- GFE
- MEE
- Other / Not listed
- Prefer not to answer

4. **S4. What is your current year of study?**

Mark only one oval.

- 1st year
- 2nd year
- 3rd year
- 4th year
- 5th year or above
- Graduate / Master's student
- Prefer not to answer

Section 2 - AI response scenarios

5. **Q1. AI disagrees with your answer** *

You solve a multiple-choice coursework question yourself and choose B. An AI assistant chooses D and provides an explanation. You do not know which answer is correct. What would you do first?

Mark only one oval.

- Check the relevant course material.
- Solve the question again independently, without consulting the AI explanation.
- Ask the same AI why option B is incorrect.
- Ask a different AI the original question.
- Change my answer to D without further checking.
- Keep my answer B without further checking.

6. **Q2. Two AI assistants disagree** *

You have not solved a question yourself. You submit the identical question to two AI assistants. One chooses B and the other D; both explanations appear plausible to you. What would you do first?

Mark only one oval.

- Check the relevant course material.
- Solve the question independently without using either AI explanation.
- Send the second explanation to the first AI and ask it to compare them.
- Ask a third AI the original question.
- Choose the answer from the AI I use more often, without further checking.
- Leave the question unanswered for now and move to another task.

7. **Q3. A cited paper cannot be located** *

An AI supports a factual claim with a paper title. You search for that exact title on Google Scholar and find no result. What would you do next?

Mark only one oval.

- Independently search for another source to verify the claim.
- Ask the same AI for the paper's DOI or direct link.
- Ask a different AI whether the claim is correct.
- Use the claim in my work but omit the citation.
- Remove the claim from my work without investigating further.

Section 3 - Understanding and AI consistency

8. **Q4. One reasoning step is unclear** *

An AI provides a worked solution. You understand the other steps but cannot see why step 3 leads to step 4. What would you do first?

Mark only one oval.

- Look up the relevant concept or formula in course materials.
- Attempt to derive step 4 from step 3 myself.
- Ask the same AI to explain that specific transition.
- Ask a classmate to explain that specific transition.
- Use the solution without clarifying that step.

9. **Q5. AI changes its answer without new evidence** *

An AI initially chooses B. You ask only “Are you sure?” and provide no new information. The AI apologizes and changes its answer to D. What would you do next?

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ Check the relevant course material.
- ◯ Solve the question independently.
- ◯ Ask the AI to compare both answers and explain why it changed.
- ◯ Ask a different AI the original question.
- ◯ Accept D without further checking.
- ◯ Keep B without further checking.

Section 4 - AI usage background

10. **Q6. On how many of the past seven days did you use a generative AI assistant for coursework?**

Mark only one oval.

	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
days	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	days

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